

Perspective:

Perspective has a Latin root meaning "looking through" or "perceive", and all the meanings of Perspective have something to do with looking.

Sociological Perspective:

Study the General in a particular way is known as ~~so~~ sociological perspective. Seeing the strange in a familiar way is called sociological perspective.

Major Sociological Perspective:

- i) The functionalist perspective. (ii) The conflict perspective.
- ii) The interactionist perspective. (iv) The Feminist perspective.
- (v) The Evolutionary perspective.

i) The functionalist perspective:

The functionalist perspective is also known as structural perspective. It is introduced by "Emile Durkheim". According to the functionalist perspective "Society is a system made up of a number of interrelated and interdependent elements, each performing a function that contributes to the operation of the whole. When all parts work together, society runs smoothly. It should be obvious that a change in one element of society will probably lead to changes to their other parts. Small change can usually be absorbed with relative ease, but large or sudden changes can come major social disruption, and lead to problems.

Example: The road transport organization which is also interlinked with educational institutes, Financial institutes, electricity, civil aviation, Police etc. If there is strike or any sort of disruption the employees of all depts. will be equally affected and may paralyze the function.

iv) The Conflict perspective:

Conflict theory derives from the ideas of Karl Marx. It is a framework for building theory that sees society as an area of inequality that generate conflict and change. Conflict theory focuses on the competition b/w groups within society over limited resources. Unlike functionalist theory, conflict theory is better at explaining social change, and weaker at explaining social stability. It is macro-level analysis of society.

Example : Feminism is an example of how a focus on power and inequality can bring about change in the situation of the female in society and a positive move towards gender equality.

iii) The interactionist perspective:

The interactionist perspective is also known as symbolic interactionism. It is introduced by "George Herbert Mead". It totally focus on social structure. It include interaction with all (living/non-living). It is micro-level study b/c it focuses on relationship among individual within society. It varies from culture to culture or society to society.

Facts: (i) we can communicate people non-verbally by using symbols, face expression. (ii). These symbols has specific meanings which is given by society or culture.

Thumb up symbol is more like appreciation or good luck wishes in western side and other cultures, but in other places like Russia and Greece it seemed as an insult.

The Feminist Perspective:

- Feminist is a perspective that views society as traditionally unequal b/w men and women and strives for equality b/w the sexes.
- Feminist perspective works towards equality, not female superiority.
- It focuses on the social, Economical and political rights of female.
- It aims to understand the nature of gender inequality, and examines women's social roles, experiences, and interests.

The Evolutionary Perspective:

- This is the earliest perspective in sociology based on the work of August Comte and Spencer.
- According to this perspective, it focuses on how human societies originate and grow over the period of time.
- Sociologists use this perspective to look for the pattern of change and development appearing in different societies in different times.
- According to this perspective, if we want to explain something then we must go to its past and foundation.

Interest of Evolutionary Thinkers:

The basis of Evolutionary perspective consist of following thinkers.

- i) Ibn-e-Khaldun.
- ii) Herbert Spencer.
- iii) Ferdinand Tönnies.

- These thinkers were interested in the study of origin, gradually growth, change and Development of society.

iii) Material culture:

Material culture consists of man-made objects such as furniture, automobiles, buildings, dams, bridges, roads etc. Such culture that we can touch is called material culture. It includes technical and material equipment like a railways engines, publication machines etc. It includes our financial institutions, postments, insurance policies etc.

iv) Non-material culture:

Such culture that we can't touch is called n-m.c. When the term culture is used in the ordinary sense, means non-material. It includes values, beliefs, symbols, organization and institutions etc.

Elements of culture:

1) Language:

- Language is the symbolic system by which people in a culture communicate with one another.
- People use language both spoken and written to transmit culture from one generation to the next.
- Most cultures are brought together by a common language and way of speaking.

2) Symbols:

- Culture relies on symbols in the form of words, gestures and actions to express meaning.
- Traditional symbols of cultural groups include the flag of a culture as well as elements like national birds or flowers.
- Societies create new symbols all the time.

3) Taboos:

Cultural taboos are things that are considered shocking or shameful within a culture.

An example of an American taboo is not tipping the waitress. If you failed to tip the waitress, you would be very much frowned upon.

4) Laws:

Every country has its own rules and regulation. All the peoples must be follows these rules and regulations. If anyone do not follows the rules then state take action and punished him.

5) values:

Values are society's ideas about what is good or bad, right or wrong.

- values determine who individuals will probably respond in any given circumstances.

6) Beliefs:

Beliefs are specific statements that people who share a culture hold to be true. For example a qualified woman could be elected president.

7) Artifacts:

The physical human creation is called artifacts. e.g furniture.

8) Norms: imp.

culture differ widely in their norms, or rules and expectations for behaving. Norms are often divided into two types.

→ **Formal norms:** Formal norms also called mores and laws, refers to the standards of behaviour considered the most important in any society. i.e not speaking lie.

→ **Informal norms:** It is also called folkways and customs, refers to standard of behaviour that are considered less important but still influence how we behave.

A high school graduate chooses a ~~career~~ career in business management after participating in a small group career seminar led by college business majors.

3- Developmental Socialization:

This type of socialization involves a learning process wherein the focus is on developing our social skills.

Example: A shy senior high school student starts to teach English to new freshmen students in order to develop verbal communication.

4- Anticipatory Socialization:

This type of socialization refers to the process wherein a person practices or rehearses for future social relationships.

Example: A child anticipates parenthood as he observes his parents perform their daily roles.

5- Resocialization:

This type of socialization involves rejecting previous behaviour patterns and accepting new ones so the individual can shift from one part of his life to another.

Example: Examples are strip searches, fingerprinting, and assigning serial numbers or code names to replace the residents given names.

Importance / Function:

- 1- Socialization converts man, the biological being into man, the social being.
- 2- Soc- contributes to the development of personality. Personality is a product of society. In the absence of groups or society, no man can

- es develop a personality of his own. But soc-
- 1 is a process through which the personality of
- ge the new born child is shaped and molded.
- 3 soc- helps to become disciplined.
- 4- Soc- helps to enact different roles.
- g 5- Soc- provides the knowledge of skills.
- 6- Soc- helps to develop right aspiration in life.
- 7- Soc- contributes to the stability of the social order.
- 8- Soc-It helps to reduce social distance.
- 9- It provides scope for building the bright
- tion. future.
10. Through soc- we can learn our culture and become fully human.

Agents of socialization:

Agents of socialization are the people, groups, and social institutions that affect one's self-concept, attitudes, and behaviour.

For example, parents, teachers, priests, television personalities, rock stars and so forth.